My Team Leadership and Performance Management Plan

This plan has been developed to support effective managerial decision-making, strengthen coaching practices, and establish a clear, inspiring vision that guides team alignment and performance.

Project summary

Your organization is facing an important moment of operational change, where team alignment, performance, and clarity have become essential. You manage a 12-member technical customer support team, and recent shifts in employee expectations have led to rising questions about transitioning to a work-from-home model. While several team members believe remote work can improve productivity and work–life balance, others prefer the structure and collaboration of the office. At the same time, senior executives strongly favor in-office work to support teamwork, coaching, and culture. Alongside this team-wide discussion, you are also managing a significant performance challenge. One of your direct reports, Jordan, has shown a steady decline in both behavior and results, creating tension within the team and impacting customer experience. Previous informal conversations have not led to improvement, and a more structured coaching approach is now required. In addition, the new fiscal year is approaching, and your leaders have asked you to develop a clear and motivating vision that will guide your team's direction, goals, and culture for the year ahead.

Your mission is to bring these priorities together by making a sound management decision on the work-from-home request, coaching Jordan effectively, and creating a compelling team vision that inspires alignment and performance.

Developing my plan, step by step

Task 1: Making a high-quality management decision

Your first task is to use structured reasoning to assess your team's work-from-home request and arrive at a fair, well-supported decision that balances evidence, team needs, and organizational priorities.

1.1 My situation assessment

Serial No.	Area reviewed	Insights/Observations
1.	Team preferences and morale	Several team members associate remote work with autonomy and improved work–life balance. Others feel they collaborate better in person. There is visible tension due to differing expectations.
2.	Operational feasibility	Our work requires real-time collaboration for customer escalations, shadowing sessions for new

		hires, and cross-functional alignment. These activities are smoother in the office.
3.	Technology readiness	While the team is technically equipped for remote work, gaps exist in remote collaboration discipline, such as inconsistent documentation, delayed responses, and unclear ownership during escalations.
4.	Leadership expectations	Senior leaders strongly prefer office-based work to foster coaching, consistency, and culture. The organization is emphasizing predictability, service quality, and collective performance.
5.	Risks and trade-offs	A full work-from-home shift may impact service quality, slow down peer learning, and reduce visibility for new team members. A full office mandate may reduce morale for some. A blended option may create confusion unless guidelines are clear.
6.	Impact on collaboration, service quality, or culture	Based on challenges highlighted in readings, psychological safety, communication clarity, and team trust improve when norms are visible and reinforced. In-office structure supports this consistency.

1.2 Evidence and inputs consulted

List the key sources of information you reviewed to support your decision.

Serial No.	Category	Source/Reference used	Value added
1.	Internal team data	Weekly quality scores, response times, and customer satisfaction trends from the last quarter	Slower escalations and reduced peer collaboration during the period when informal remote days were allowed.
2.	Organizational guidelines/policies	Leadership communication emphasizing in-office collaboration for coaching, culture, and consistency	Reinforced the priority of standardizing practices and strengthening team cohesion.
3.	Industry or real-world examples	Case studies from the readings on how unclear expectations reduce accountability in hybrid setups	Helped evaluate risks of partial remote models without strong norms.

4.	Productivity or customer impact data	Recent customer complaints related to handover delays and inconsistent updates	Indicated that remote work, without structured processes, may reduce service reliability.

1.3 My final decision and rationale

Serial No.	My decision	Why is this the right decision for the team and organization
1.	Adopt a structured hybrid model with fixed in-office anchor days (3 days/week) and flexible remote days (2 days/week), supported by clear communication norms, documentation expectations, and structured check-ins.	This decision balances team preferences with organizational expectations. It protects service quality, ensures coaching visibility, and reduces operational risk while still offering flexibility. The structured hybrid model aligns with the course learning that clarity, consistency, and predictable norms improve team performance and psychological safety.

1.4 Leadership communication strategy

Describe how you will communicate your decision in a clear, empathetic, and structured way.

Serial No.	Element	My communication approach
1.	Primary communication format	Announce the decision through a team meeting, followed by a written summary for clarity and transparency
2.	Key message frame (“what, why, how”)	Clearly explain what the hybrid structure is, why it supports performance and team culture, and how we will operationalize it using norms and check-ins
3.	Tone and emotional cues	Supportive, empathetic, and transparent. Acknowledge mixed preferences and emphasize fairness and shared success
4.	How I will address concerns/questions	Create space for honest questions, invite suggestions, and reinforce

		psychological safety by validating different viewpoints
5.	Follow-through or next-step actions	Share a working norms document, align expectations in the next team meeting, and review the model at the 60-day mark

Task 2: Coaching an underperforming direct report

The next step is to design a structured coaching plan to help Jordan improve performance and re-engage with the team.

2.1 Coaching conversation structure

Serial No.	Conversation stage	How I will lead this stage
1.	Establish the purpose and set a supportive tone	Begin with appreciation for past strengths, clarify that the conversation aims to support his success, and emphasize partnership rather than criticism
2.	Present specific observations	Use objective examples from the last 3–4 weeks (missed deadlines, incomplete tickets, inconsistent communication) framed through facts without judgment
3.	Explore Jordan's perspective	Ask open-ended questions to understand root causes, workload challenges, clarity gaps, motivation issues, or external factors
4.	Clarify expectations and success criteria	Reiterate performance standards from the readings: clear communication, timely handovers, proactive problem-solving, and consistent adherence to service norms
5.	Co-design an improvement plan	Collaborate to define concrete behaviors, support needs, tools, or training that would enable improvement
6.	Agree on timelines, checkpoints, and support	Set a 4-week plan with weekly check-ins, shadowing opportunities, and clear milestones
7.	Close with clarity and encouragement	Reinforce confidence in his ability to progress, summarize agreements, and express ongoing support

2.2 Diagnostic and developmental questions

Create thoughtful questions that help Jordan reflect, understand the impact of his actions, and take ownership of improvement

Serial No.	Questions I will ask	Leadership purpose of this question
1.	What challenges have been affecting your recent performance, and how have they impacted your work?	Helps uncover root causes and encourage self-awareness
2.	How do you think your recent actions have influenced customer experience and team workflows?	Encourages reflection on impact and accountability
3.	What changes or support would help you get back to the level of performance you expect from yourself?	Promotes ownership and a solutions-oriented mindset

2.3 Psychological safety actions

Identify the actions you will take to create a safe, respectful environment where Jordan feels supported and able to speak openly.

Serial No.	What I will do	How does this build psychological safety
1.	Use a calm tone, validate feelings, and avoid blame-based language during coaching	Helps Jordan feel respected and reduces defensiveness
2.	Share clear roles, expectations, and support options upfront	Creates clarity, reduces uncertainty, and increases trust that improvement is possible

Task 3: Creating and communicating team vision

Craft a concise vision that guides team direction and motivates team members at the start of the new fiscal year.

3.1 My team vision statement

We deliver service excellence through clarity, collaboration, and empathy, ensuring every customer interaction is consistent, timely, and supportive, while fostering a team culture grounded in trust, accountability, and shared growth.

3.2 Vision communication plan

Explain how you will introduce your team vision and reinforce it consistently through different communication methods.

Serial No.	Communication method	How I will use it to bring the vision to life
1.	Team meeting or kickoff	Introduce the new vision with a short story reflecting our team's impact and align it with organizational priorities
2.	Visual or written summary	Share a one-page "Team Vision Card" summarizing key themes, goals, and behaviors
3.	Storytelling or examples	Highlight real scenarios from customer interactions where collaborative effort created positive outcomes
4.	Integration into goals, rituals, or metrics	Embed the vision in weekly check-ins, performance goals, recognition systems, and quarterly reviews.

3.3 Team involvement strategy

Describe how you will involve the team in shaping, practicing, and sustaining the vision throughout the year.

Serial No.	Engagement step	What this generates for the team
1.	Hold a short workshop where team members identify behaviors that bring the vision to life	Builds shared ownership and creates clarity on daily expectations
2.	Create peer-led micro-initiatives (e.g., "best handover practices," "customer empathy boosters") aligned with the vision	Encourages collaboration and accountability
3.	Review progress monthly and celebrate examples of the vision in action	Reinforces consistency, recognition, and a culture of continuous improvement